

Pierre Kengne Nkola

Piscataway, NJ | brad.knp@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/pierre-knp

SUMMARY

Principal DevSecOps Engineer & 8x AWS Certified Solutions Architect (Professional-level SA & DevOps, ML Specialty) leading cloud migrations, platform engineering, and applied GenAI initiatives for regulated financial services firms. AWS re:Invent speaker; former AWS Senior Solutions Architect.

SKILLS

Python, Go, Java, C++, TypeScript, Bash • AWS (EKS, IAM, CloudFormation, CDK, CodePipeline, Bedrock), Terraform, Kubernetes, Docker, Backstage, Azure DevOps, GitLab, CI/CD • Postgres, SQL, NoSQL, MongoDB, Snowflake • GenAI/RAG, Bedrock, MCP, Agents • NIST compliance, CrowdStrike, security automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal DevSecOps Engineer — Fi-Tek, Edison, NJ 10/2024 – Present

- Led Fi-Tek's AI-first initiative: designed & shipped a Bedrock/RAG Intelligent Document Processing platform letting trust officers query legal documents in natural language — first GenAI feature in production, presented at company conference.
- Rescued a stalled \$1.5M AWS migration after a consulting engagement left hundreds of NIST/Config findings open; built a CI/CD pipeline (Azure DevOps→AWS, cross-account StackSets, cfn-guard gates) and led the on-prem-to-AWS migration for ~100 bank/trust customers.
- Designed a near-real-time Snowflake ↔ AWS ↔ on-prem data exchange platform streaming 20+ views via Snowflake Streams/Tasks and a serverless AWS pipeline, plus a 15-view partner outbound feed.

Senior Solutions Architect — Amazon Web Services, New York, NY 01/2022 – 10/2024

- Designed a Backstage-based internal developer platform with a self-service multi-tenant EKS runtime (IRSA, namespace RBAC, 3-env promotion), removing direct IAM/VPC exposure for customer engineering teams.
- Designed a multi-account, multi-region backup-and-restore architecture for a regulated financial institution using AWS Organizations, StackSets, and IAM role chaining for least-privilege separation across dozens of accounts.
- Led migrations of legacy monoliths to Kubernetes/Docker microservices and delivered EC2 right-sizing initiatives that cut customer compute spend.

Senior Software Engineer — Diebold Nixdorf, New York, NY 08/2018 – 01/2022

- Cut AWS compute costs by implementing Kubernetes auto-scaling and right-sizing across production workloads.
- Re-architected a critical server-side system with automation and security hardening to meet regulatory requirements, directly enabling the acquisition of new enterprise customers.

Software Engineer — Societe Generale, Douala, Cameroon 03/2014 – 03/2017

- Built RESTful APIs powering a mobile banking platform serving 500,000+ concurrent users.
- Built internal tooling to automate vulnerability scanning and patching; resolved device-compatibility issues, cutting user-reported incidents 92%.

CERTIFICATIONS & HONORS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional • AWS Certified DevOps Engineer – Professional • AWS Certified Machine Learning – Specialty • 8x AWS Certified (total) • AWS re:Invent Speaker • Speaker, Wealth Management Conference • Languages: French, English

EDUCATION

New Jersey Institute of Technology (NJIT) — B.S. Computer Science, GPA 4.0 09/2020 – 12/2023

ISEM-IBCG, Douala, Cameroon — B.S. Mathematics 09/2010 – 12/2013